

Home Life

Before The Uncommon Parenting Shift

Read through these questions and add a few words wherever useful. You do not need long answers, and 'I'm not sure' is fine. Leave anything you would rather discuss on the call blank. Keep your answers and bring them with you. You do not need to send them beforehand. We will go through them together, so we get a picture of what's going on.

A picture of an ordinary day

Answer about life now, whatever your child's age. If earlier years feel relevant, add a note. Consider what fits their age, maturity and circumstances.

What does a usual day look like? Include time with you, other caregivers, nursery, school or work.

When are things easiest between you? What is happening then?

When do things become difficult? Give one recent example: what happened just before, what your child did and what you did.

What have you tried, and what happens afterwards?

What do you find yourself thinking in that moment? Use your own words.

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What you notice in yourself

For each statement, tick what fits most often. These are prompts for discussion, not scores or a test. Add an example in the space below.

I notice when I am getting tense or frustrated.

☐ Rarely ☐ Sometimes ☐ Often ☐ Not sure

I sound calm even when I do not feel calm.

☐ Rarely ☐ Sometimes ☐ Often ☐ Not sure

My voice becomes sharper or louder than I wanted.

☐ Rarely ☐ Sometimes ☐ Often ☐ Not sure

I feel rushed, distracted or only half there.

☐ Rarely ☐ Sometimes ☐ Often ☐ Not sure

I feel I should be doing more, or being a different kind of parent.

☐ Rarely ☐ Sometimes ☐ Often ☐ Not sure

Is there an example you would like to talk through?

After a difficult moment, what helps you come back to being with your child?

Who can you turn to for company, practical help or support? Is enough available?

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How life unfolds between you

Helping, saying no, talking and holding boundaries need the context of the moment. We will explore that together, rather than treating any one action as right or wrong.

When your child wants to be near you or join what you are doing, what usually happens?

How do you decide when to help, when to let them carry on and when to say no?

What do you tend to say through the day? Do you notice explaining, questioning, correcting or calling from another room?

How do touch, affection and time together fit your child now? What do they welcome or avoid?

What happens when you make a request or hold a boundary? How do other caregivers respond?

Which approaches do you currently use? Tick any that fit.

- ☐ Rewards or praise ☐ Punishments or consequences ☐ Time-outs or isolation
☐ Bargaining or counting ☐ Explaining or reassurance ☐ Something else

Anything else you want us to explore, including the approach you ticked above?